

DD Daniel Davies

Designing Assessment for a Generative AI World

A short staff module on constructive alignment, the AI Assessment Scale, and rewriting a Level 4 business task

- Welcome: How to use this module
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- Rewriting a Level 4 business task
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Welcome: How to use this module

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Welcome

Welcome to this short staff module on designing assessment in a generative AI world.

The module is for lecturers, especially those teaching business or a related subject. It is written in plain English and takes about 12 to 15 minutes. You can pause and come back.

By the end, you will be able to:

• explain constructive alignment in plain terms, and why a generative AI tool can weaken a take-home task

• describe the five levels of the current AI Assessment Scale, and treat them as kinds of task rather than as a ranking

• tell the difference between a genuine redesign and only adding a label

• work through a rewritten Level 4 business assessment, and take one idea back to your own module

This module was designed by Daniel P Davies, Associate Lecturer at Liverpool John Moores University. He teaches business, and his doctoral research looks at AI-supported feedback and assessment for Level 4 international business students.

Start with the learning outcome, then design the task.
Do not start with a ban, or with a tool.

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How to use this module

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Step 1

Work through the lessons in order

There are three short lessons after this welcome, then a five-question quiz. Each lesson builds on the last.

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Step 2

Try every activity

You will see questions, a labelled scale, and a short sorting task. These are for practice. You can retry them.

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Step 3

Keep one of your own tasks beside you

If you can, have one current brief open. In the last lesson you will see a worked rewrite. The aim is to leave with one change you could make to your own task.

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Step 4

Check your own context

This module uses generic examples. Your own regulations, level descriptors, and professional body rules still apply. The scale is a design tool, not a replacement for local policy.

A note about the examples

All sample briefs, company names, figures, and rubrics in this module are generic examples only. They were written for teaching. They are not from a real module, and they do not use real student work or real marks.

Your own assignments will look different. The method should still transfer: start with the outcome, choose the role that generative AI should play, and redesign the evidence and the rubric so that a grade still means what you want it to mean.

CONTINUE

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Lesson 2 of 6

Start with constructive alignment

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Three parts that need to line up

Biggs (1996) described constructive alignment as a way of designing teaching so that three things point in the same direction:

- the intended learning outcomes: what students should be able to do

- the teaching and learning activities: what students do in order to become able to do it

- the assessment: the task that asks them to show that performance

In plain terms, you decide the performance you want, you teach in a way that makes that performance likely, and you assess that same performance.

This still holds in a generative AI world. What has changed is how easily a take-home task can be completed without the student doing the thinking the outcome names. If a tool can produce a fluent generic essay, and the mark is based on that essay alone, the assessment may no longer be a valid picture of the outcome.

The question is not only "Are students allowed to use a tool?" The deeper question is: "Does this task still elicit the performance I say I am marking?"

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1. What should students be able to do?	This is the intended outcome. Write it as a performance, not only as a topic. For example: "Recommend a justified market-entry mode, using evidence," not only "Understand market entry."
2. What will students do to get there?	These are the teaching and learning activities. Students need practice at the same kind of performance they will later be asked to show, including, where relevant, practice at judging and improving tool output.

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3. How will they show it?	This is the assessment. The task, the conditions, the evidence you collect, and the rubric should all point back to the same performance. If a tool can do the assessed part without the student, the alignment is weak.

If the task no longer asks for the performance named in the outcome, the assessment is out of line.

A Level 4 module outcome says: "Students will be able to recommend a justified market-entry mode, using evidence from a specific case." The only assessment is a 1,500-word take-home essay titled "The advantages and disadvantages of foreign market entry modes." There is no case pack, and no process evidence. Why is constructive alignment weak here?

- Because take-home essays are no longer allowed.
- Because a fluent generic essay may not show a justified recommendation about a specific case, which is the

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performance the outcome names.

- ◯ Because students will enjoy the task too much, so it cannot be valid.
- ◯ Because the outcome uses the word "recommend," which is too vague to assess.

SUBMIT

Complete the content above before moving on.

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The AI Assessment Scale

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A shared language for the role of AI

The AI Assessment Scale (AIAS) was first published by Perkins, Furze, Roe, and MacVaugh (2024). It gave educators and students a shared language for the role that generative AI might play in a task, instead of a simple yes-or-no rule.

Perkins, Roe, and Furze (2025b) then published a revised version. That is the version used in this module. The revised scale still has five levels, but the names and the purpose have been sharpened. The authors present it as a framework for redesigning assessment, not as a set of labels to stick on unchanged briefs. They also moved away from a traffic-light colour scheme, so that no level looks "better" or "safer" than another.

The five short names, as used in Perkins, Roe, and Furze (2025b, Table 1) and in Perkins, Roe, and Furze (2025a), are:

1. No AI

2. AI Planning

3. AI Collaboration

4. Full AI

5. AI Exploration

In the 2025b paper, Level 2 is also discussed as "AI-Assisted Planning," and Level 3 as "AI-Assisted Task Completion." If you read the article, those are the same two levels, not extra ones.

No level is a promotion, and no level is a penalty. The right level is the one that fits the outcome you want to assess.



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Level 1: No AI

Students complete the task in a controlled environment that is designed to exclude generative AI. They show knowledge, skills, or understanding without that help. Perkins, Roe, and Furze (2025b) argue that a "no AI" claim on unsupervised take-home work is hard to defend. If you need unaided performance, design the conditions so that this can be assured, and plan for accessible alternatives where assistive technology is needed.

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Level 2: AI Planning

The task is about planning: exploring a topic, outlining, or early research. Students may use a generative AI tool to support that planning. What you mark is the quality of the plan and the development of ideas, whether or not a tool was used. The task itself must make that planning visible. Naming the level on an unchanged essay is not enough (Perkins, Roe, & Furze, 2025b).

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Level 3: AI Collaboration

Students may use a tool to help complete the task, including ideas, drafting, feedback, and refinement. The design should still require the student's judgement, voice, and subject knowledge. You assess the work, and you assess how tool output was evaluated, changed, and integrated (Perkins, Roe, & Furze, 2025b).

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Level 4: Full AI

Tool use is expected. The task is set so that neither a person working alone, nor a tool working alone, could reasonably meet the goal in the time available. You mark the critical thinking and subject knowledge shown in how the student directs the tool (Perkins, Roe, & Furze, 2025b). This still needs a redesigned brief, not only a new label.

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Level 5: AI Exploration

The task is designed for creative or innovative use of AI to solve problems or develop new approaches in the discipline. Students and lecturers may co-design the approach (Perkins, Roe, & Furze, 2025b). This level is often more suitable for later or more open projects than for a typical Level 4 taught task, but the idea is useful: some outcomes are about exploration, not only about a fixed product.

NO AI	AI PLANNING	AI COLLABORATION	FULL AI	AI E

A short, supervised case analysis, or a viva, in which students use a paper pack and recommend a next step. This can be the right choice when you need an unaided picture of a foundation skill, such as reading a simple set of figures and explaining a recommendation in the student's own words.

NO AI	AI PLANNING	AI COLLABORATION	FULL AI	AI E

Students submit a one-page plan and a set of questions for a later briefing. They may use a tool to help them explore options and structure the plan. You mark the quality of the plan, the questions,

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and the way ideas have been refined, not a finished report.

NO AI	AI PLANNING	AI COLLABORATION	FULL AI	AI E

Students write a management briefing on a provided case pack. They may use a tool to help with ideas, drafting, and refinement. They also submit a short commentary on what they asked of the tool, what they changed, and why. The pack, the judgement, and the commentary are what make the standard hard to reach by a tool alone.

NO AI	AI PLANNING	AI COLLABORATION	FULL AI	AI E

Students are asked to direct a tool to produce a first-cut market scan, then to interrogate, correct, and present that scan, including limits and risks. You mark how well they directed the work and how well they judged the output, not whether they typed every sentence.

NO AI	AI PLANNING	AI COLLABORATION	FULL AI	AI E

In a later or more open project, students and the lecturer agree a novel use of a tool to investigate a business problem that does not already have a set answer, and they document the approach as well as the result. For many taught Level 4 modules, Levels 1 to 3 will be the more common choices.

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An unenforceable "No AI" label

Putting "No AI" on a take-home essay, with no controlled conditions, is a rule that you cannot reliably assure. The authors argue that Level 1 needs a setting in which the absence of a tool can be reasonably assured. If you cannot provide that setting, another level, with a redesigned task, is usually the more honest choice.

A label without a redesign

Adding "This is a Level 3 task" to an unchanged brief does not change what the task measures. Perkins, Roe, and Furze (2025a, 2025b) are clear that the scale should drive structural change: the role of the tool, the evidence of process, the checkpoints, and the rubric. A label on its own is a change that students can ignore.

Equity as an afterthought

Students do not all have the same access to paid tools, and a blanket ban can also get in the way of legitimate assistive technology. The authors ask educators to design for fairness: be clear about which tools are permitted or provided, and do not rely on detection to police unsupervised work.

"Full AI" as a way to avoid the problem

Moving a task to Full AI, without changing what students must show, does not solve a design problem. Perkins, Roe, and Furze (2025a) warn against changing the level simply to sidestep integrity concerns. Full AI is a genuine design choice only when the outcome is about directing a tool, and the task and rubric are rebuilt around that performance.

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According to this lesson, what is the main job of the AI Assessment Scale?

- To rank tasks from "best" (No AI) to "riskiest" (AI Exploration).
- To help you choose the role of AI that fits the outcome, and then redesign the task, the evidence, and the rubric.
- To detect whether a student has used a generative AI tool.
- To replace your institution's assessment policy.

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Lesson 4 of 6

Rewriting a Level 4 business task

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A familiar brief, and why it is fragile

Here is a generic example only. It is not a real module brief.

Module (invented): Level 4 Business Environment

Outcome (as written): Students will be able to recommend a justified market-entry mode, using evidence from a specific case.

Current task: Write a 1,500-word essay titled "The advantages and disadvantages of foreign market entry modes."

Conditions: Take-home, end of term. No draft, no case pack, and no process evidence.

Current rubric: Knowledge of entry modes (50%). Structure and academic style (50%).

The outcome asks for a justified recommendation about a specific case. The task asks for a generic essay. The rubric does not mark the recommendation, the use of a case, or any judgement of sources or tools.

A generative AI tool can now produce a fluent version of this essay. If we mark that product alone, we may be marking fluency rather than the performance the outcome names.

The next blocks rewrite the task at Level 3, AI Collaboration. That is one defensible choice for this outcome, not the only possible choice. A short supervised case (Level 1) could also be aligned, if what you need is an unaided picture of the same skill.

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Step 1

Keep the outcome in view

The performance we want is: recommend a justified market-entry mode, using evidence from a specific case. We will not change the outcome just to make life easier for a tool, or harder for a tool. We will change the task so that it asks for that performance.

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Step 2

Choose the role of AI

For a taught Level 4 briefing, Level 3 (AI Collaboration) is a good fit. Students may use a tool for ideas, drafting, and refinement, but they must still use the case, make the recommendation, and show how they judged any tool output. If

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we needed an unaided snapshot of the same skill, we would choose Level 1 and provide controlled conditions instead.

Step 3

Redesign the evidence

We give students a short company pack (invented for teaching). We shorten the written product to a 1,000-word briefing, add a 300-word commentary on tool use, and add a five-minute in-class explanation of the recommendation. The pack, the commentary, and the short oral explanation give us more than one window on the same outcome.

Step 4

Align the rubric and the teaching

The rubric now marks use of the pack, the quality of the recommendation, evaluation of any tool output, and professional communication (including the short explanation). Teaching includes a workshop on entry modes with the same

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pack, and a short practice activity on checking and improving tool output. Students practise the performance they will later show.

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BEFORE	AFTER (LEVEL 3: AI COLLABORATION)	THE REDESIGNED RUBRIC	WHAT TEACHING NEEDS TO DO

Write a 1,500-word take-home essay: "The advantages and disadvantages of foreign market entry modes." No case pack. No process evidence. Rubric: knowledge 50%, style 50%. The outcome names a justified, case-based recommendation, but the task does not ask for one.

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BEFORE	AFTER (LEVEL 3: AI COLLABORATION)	THE REDESIGNED RUBRIC	WHAT TEACHING NEEDS TO DO

Write a 1,000-word management briefing for Harbour & Oak, a fictional UK homeware retailer. Recommend whether the firm should enter the Westhaven market through a franchise, a joint venture, or e-commerce only. Use only the company pack provided. You may use a generative AI tool to help you generate ideas, draft, and refine your writing. A tool alone will not meet the standard: you must use the pack, make a clear recommendation, and show your reasoning. Add a 300-word commentary that explains what you asked of the tool, what you changed, and why. You will also give a five-minute in-class explanation of your recommendation.

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BEFORE	AFTER (LEVEL 3: AI COLLABORATION)	THE REDESIGNED RUBRIC	WHAT TEACHING NEEDS TO DO
Use of the company pack and relevant concepts (30%). Quality of the justified recommendation (30%). Evaluation and integration of any AI output, including the commentary (20%). Professional communication, including the in-class explanation (20%). Each criterion now points back to the outcome, or to the judgement that Level 3 requires.			

BEFORE	AFTER (LEVEL 3: AI COLLABORATION)	THE REDESIGNED RUBRIC	WHAT TEACHING NEEDS TO DO
A workshop uses the same pack to practise reading evidence and making a recommendation. A short taught activity shows how to check tool output for missing risks, generic claims, and invented sources, and how to keep the student's own voice. Students also practise a two-minute explanation, so the in-class element is not a surprise. Teaching, task, and rubric now point the same way.			

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A redesign

Ask students to submit a short commentary on what they asked of a tool, what the

Replace the generic essay with a briefing that must use a provided case pack.

Change the rubric so that it marks evaluation of tool output and the quality of

Only a label

Add "AIAS Level 3" to the top of the unchanged 1,500-word essay brief.

Write "No AI" on a take-home essay, and leave the conditions unchanged.

Relabel the same essay as "Full AI" so that integrity is no longer a concern.

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In the rewritten Harbour & Oak task, what is the best reason for including the 300-word commentary and the five-minute in-class explanation?

- To make the assignment longer, so that a tool cannot finish it.
- To collect more than one piece of evidence of the same outcome, including the student's judgement of any tool output.
- To catch students out, so that you can prove they used a tool.
- To replace the need for a rubric.

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Continue to the quiz

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Lesson 5 of 6

Check your learning

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This short quiz has five questions. It checks the ideas you have just practised. You can retry it. You need 4 out of 5 to pass. After the quiz, there is a short closing note and a further-reading list.

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Question

01/05

According to Biggs (1996), constructive alignment means:

- Writing outcomes, then leaving teaching and assessment to be decided later.
- Designing the outcomes, the teaching and learning activities, and the assessment so that they ask for the same performance.
- Making sure every assessment is an unseen examination.
- Allowing students to choose any assessment format they prefer.

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Question

02/05

Who first published the AI Assessment Scale, and who published the revised version used in this module?

- ◯ Both versions were published by Biggs in 1996.
- ◯ The revised scale came first, in 2024, and the original followed in 2025.
- ◯ The original scale is Perkins, Furze, Roe, and MacVaugh (2024). The revised version used here is Perkins, Roe, and Furze (2025b).
- ◯ The scale has no published source, only a website.

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Question

03/05

In the revised AI Assessment Scale, Level 1 (No AI) is most defensible when:

- You add the words "No AI" to a take-home essay, and rely on students to follow the rule.
- The outcome requires unaided performance, and the task takes place in a controlled environment designed to exclude generative AI.
- You want the most prestigious kind of assessment, because No AI is the top of the scale.
- You are unsure what the outcome is, so a ban is the safest starting point.

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Question

04/05

A colleague adds "This is an AI Collaboration task" to an unchanged generic essay brief, and leaves the rubric as "knowledge" and "style" only. What is the main problem?

- ◯ There is no problem, because any use of the scale is enough.
- ◯ The colleague should have written "Full AI" instead, which needs no further change.
- ◯ The level has been named, but the task, the evidence, and the rubric have not been redesigned.
- ◯ The scale cannot be used in business modules.

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Question

05/05

In the Harbour & Oak rewrite, which change does most to bring the task back into line with the outcome "recommend a justified market-entry mode, using evidence from a specific case"?

- Increasing the word count from 1,500 to 2,500 words.
- Asking students to write a briefing that uses a provided case pack, and marking the quality of the justified recommendation.
- Removing the outcome from the handbook so that there is nothing to align.
- Forbidding students from reading the case pack until after they have written the essay.

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Lesson 6 of 6

One next step

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Take one brief back to your desk

If you have one of your own Level 4 tasks to hand, try this now, or later today:

1. Write the intended performance in one sentence.

2. Choose the AI Assessment Scale level that fits that performance.

3. Change one mechanic of the task: the product, the pack, the process evidence, a short in-class checkpoint, or the rubric.

4. Check that teaching gives students a chance to practise the same performance.

You do not need to redesign a whole programme this afternoon. One aligned change is a solid start.

A grade should still mean what the outcome claims it means.

Further reading

These are the sources cited in this module. All were opened and checked when the script was written.

- Biggs, J. (1996). Enhancing teaching through constructive alignment. Higher Education, 32(3), 347–364. https://doi.org/10.1007/BF00138871

- Perkins, M., Furze, L., Roe, J., & MacVaugh, J. (2024). The Artificial Intelligence Assessment Scale (AIAS): A framework for ethical integration of generative AI in educational assessment. Journal of University Teaching and Learning Practice, 21(6). https://doi.org/10.53761/q3azde36

- Perkins, M., Roe, J., & Furze, L. (2025a). How (not) to use the AI Assessment Scale. Journal of Applied Learning & Teaching, 8(2), 14–23. https://doi.org/10.37074/jalt.2025.8.2.15

- Perkins, M., Roe, J., & Furze, L. (2025b). Reimagining the Artificial Intelligence Assessment Scale: A refined framework for educational assessment. Journal of University Teaching and Learning Practice, 22(7). https://doi.org/10.53761/rrm4y757

The authors also keep current public resources at https://aiassessmentscale.com/. This module teaches the revised scale from the 2025b paper, not from the website alone.

Heading

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